

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Transition without a political vacuum

PALA ---- PRATIHARA ---- RASHTRAKUTA competitive order

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regional redistribution

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GAHADAVALA | CHAUHAN | PARAMARA | CHALUKYA | CHANDELLA | TOMARA

SOUTHERN AXIS -> Chola state, ports and Indian Ocean networks

VERDICT: substantial state capacity survived; pooled command remained difficult.

MUST REMEMBER: Regional states and active Indian Ocean networks mean political plurality, not
a civilisational vacuum.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Four contact layers

COMMERCIAL -> Arab and Indian merchants, ports and monsoon routes

CULTURAL -> numerals, astronomy, medicine, language and translation

FRONTIER -> Sind, Kabul, Zabul, Jalalabad and Punjab

MILITARY-INSTITUTIONAL -> cavalry, roads, iqta logic and concentrated command

RULE: contact preceded conquest, and the four layers changed at different speeds.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Chronology of contact and frontier change

711-12 -> Muhammad bin Qasim establishes limited Arab rule in Sindh
963 / 977 -> Alptigin and Sabuktigin build the Ghazni frontier state
998-1030 -> Mahmud: Punjab incorporation differs from raids into the plains
1025-26 -> Somnath raid; motives and booty numbers require source caution
1178 / 1191 -> Ghurid defeats in Gujarat and Tarain I preserve contingency
1192 / 1194 -> Tarain II and Chandawar create a new conquest bridge
c. 1200 -> Aibak and eastern commanders move toward delegated state formation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Monsoon maritime circuit

PERSIAN GULF / RED SEA

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Arab and Indian merchants + monsoon navigation

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GUJARAT COAST ---- MALABAR COAST ---- SRI LANKA / SOUTHEAST ASIA

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goods + resident communities + worship spaces + knowledge

LIMIT: a mosque or merchant settlement does not prove foreign sovereignty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Sind as conquest and conduit

711-12 CAMPAIGN -> Muhammad bin Qasim defeats Dahir and holds key Sindh towns

RULE -> garrisons + taxation + retained local personnel + negotiated accommodation

LIMIT -> Sindh and Multan foothold, not a straight road to all-India conquest

CHACHNAMA -> early-13th-century Persian narrative about 8th-century events

SOURCE RULE -> chronicle + inscription + coin + archaeology must be compared

CONDUIT -> merchants + mathematics + astronomy + medicine + translation

VERDICT: limited conquest and durable contact were both historically important.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Formation of the Persianate-Turkish package

ABBASID FRAGMENTATION

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regional Iranian and Central Asian military states

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Turkic commanders + Islamisation + Persian language and court culture

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cavalry command + documentary kingship + revenue-service institutions

TRAP: Persianate describes culture and administration, not ethnicity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Frontier depth and the outer bastions

CENTRAL ASIA -> GHAZNI -> KABUL -> JALALABAD -> PUNJAB -> GANGA PLAIN

roads, bases, supply and intelligence

HINDU SHAHI CONTROL -> strategic depth

SHAHI LOSSES + PUNJAB BASE -> shorter operational corridor

COUNTER-EVIDENCE -> Gujarat 1178-79 and Tarain 1191 defeats

VERDICT: access enabled campaigns; it did not determine victory.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Rajput capacity and coordination

STRENGTHS

agrarian revenue

forts and feudatory armies

regional legitimacy

Gujarat and Tarain I victories

VERDICT: courage and capacity existed; durable common command was weaker.

LIMITS

rival sovereign centres

uneven intelligence sharing

delayed pooled reinforcement

Prithviraj's political isolation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Military-fiscal interaction

REVENUE ASSIGNMENT / IQTA LOGIC -> maintained mounted force

ROADS + BASES + REMOUNTS -> mobility and operational endurance

RECONNAISSANCE + RESERVES -> tactical flexibility

CONCENTRATED COMMAND -> rapid decision and reinforcement

NO SINGLE CAUSE: horses without finance, roads and command were insufficient.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Condition, mechanism and trigger

CONDITION -> frontier-depth loss + regional rivalry

MECHANISM -> mobility + fiscal concentration + logistics + command

TRIGGER -> leadership + diplomacy + tactical adaptation

COUNTERFACT -> Turkish reverses show structures changed odds, not certainty

FINAL FORMULA: probability, not inevitability; organisation, not race.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Arab maritime and Sind contacts preceded the later Persianate-Turkish military-state transition.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence discipline

ARABIC / PERSIAN CHRONICLES -> campaigns and ideals | patronage and hindsight

CHACHNAMA -> remembered Sindh conquest | late Persian multi-genre narrative

INSCRIPTIONS / COINS -> local acts and authority | uneven survival and reach

ARCHAEOLOGY -> ports, forts and settlements | identification and dating limits

LATER EPICS -> political memory | recension, romance and anachronism

PRITHVIRAJA VIJAYA / RASO -> nearer eulogy versus much later literary memory

METHOD: claim -> source date/genre -> corroboration -> explicit uncertainty.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Persianate identifies a cultural-administrative formation, not a single ethnicity or automatic sovereignty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 01 answer spine

OPEN -> India was connected and politically regionalised, not isolated

SEA -> trade, settlements and knowledge without automatic conquest

WEST/CENTRAL ASIA -> Persianised Turkish military states

FRONTIER -> Shahi depth, roads and Punjab base

POLITY -> Rajput capacity plus coordination limits

CAUSATION -> condition + mechanism + contingent trigger

CLOSE -> interaction and institutional recombination shaped the transition.